

Theme 12A — Any an-tsekoly (At School)

Background

Under the reign of King Radama I (1810–1828), the French Robin and Rev. Jones of the London Missionary Society (LMS) founded the first schools in Madagascar in 1820, at the initiative of a king who wanted closer ties with Europe through the religious missionaries.

Although every person has the right to education, teaching, and training, access to education remains a challenge for different reasons — parental poverty, a bad harvest, early marriage, lack of nearby infrastructure, or competing priorities. There are still those who are illiterate or leave school early. The level of schooling remains unequal across the country. State school starts at age 6, private school at age 3. University begins at around 18.

There are three official exams: at age 10, 14, and 18.

Text — A School Day

Miditra amin'ny 7 sy sasany ny mpianatra amin'ny maraina dia mirava amin'ny 11 sy sasany. Raha vao maneno ny lakolosy amin'ny 7 sy sasany dia milahatra mahitsy tsiroaroa sy mangina ny mpianatra. Miditra moramora dia miarahaba ny mpampianatra vao mipetraka dia manomboka ny fianarana. Misy fakan-drivotra 15 minitra amin'ny 9 sy sasany. Miditra amin'ny 2 sy sasany dia mirava amin'ny 4 amin'ny folakandro.

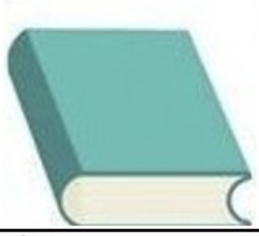
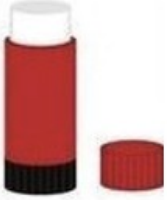
Activities

- Listen and try to understand each sentence and the text above using the vocabulary table.
- Try to retell the same story using your own school system (entry times, break times …)

Vocabulaires

Verbs	Nouns	Other words
Miditra / *Miditry* (tsm) *Start school*	**Mpianatra** *Students / pupils*	**Amin'ny fito sy sasany** 7.30
Mirava *Finish school*	**Mpampianatra** *Teacher*	**Amin'ny sivy sy sasany** 9.30
Maneno *Ring (a bell)*	**Lakolosy** *Bell*	**Amin'ny iraika ambin'ny folo sy sasany** 11.30
Milahatra *Line up*	**Fianarana** *Study / lesson*	**Amin'ny roa sy sasany** 2.30
Miditra / *Miditry* (tsm) *Enter*	**Fakan-drivotra** / *Ravankely* (tsm) *Break / recreation*	**Amin'ny efatra** 4.00
Miarahaba / *Magname salama* (tsm) *Greet*	*>> v. Maka rivotra take a break*	**Ampahefatradiny** / *Ampahefadera* (tsm) *15 minutes*
Mipetraka / *Mantotry* (tsm) *Sit down*	**Minitra** *Minute*	**Maraina** / *Maraindraignny* (tsm) *Morning*
Manomboka / *Manomboko* (tsm) *Begin / start*		**Folakandro** afternoon
		Raha vao … dia … as soon as …
		Vao / *Alôhaka* (tsm) *before*
		Tsiroaroa two by two
		Mahitsy straight / upright
		Mangina quietly / silently
		Moramora gently / slowly

Fitaovan'ny Mpianatra — School Supplies

Kitapo 	Penina 	Gaoma 	Trosy 
Boky 	Penisilihazo 	Fitsipika 	Lakaoly / dity 
Kahie 	Solaitra 	Loko 	Lokorano 
Fandrangitana 	Hety / ciseau 	Tsaoka / lakre 	

Malagasy	English	Malagasy	English	Malagasy	English
Kitapo	School bag	**Penisilihazo**	Pencil	**Loko**	Crayons
Penina	Pen	**Fitsipika**	Ruler	**Lokorano**	Watercolour paint

Gaoma	Rubber / eraser	**Lakaoly**	Glue	**Fandrangitana**	Sharpener
Trosy	Pencil case	**Kahie**	Notebook	**Hety**	Scissors
Boky	Book	**Solaitra**	Slate	**Tsaoka**	Chalk

Activity

Answer the question **AIZA NY + noun ?** (Where is the …?) by pointing to the object in the table above.

Aiza ny kitapo – penina – penisilihazo – hety – fitsipika – trosy – dity – boky – solaitra – loko – kahie – lokorano – tsaoka – fandrangitana – gaoma ?